

Life cycle of a moth

Some insects have life cycles that are so unbelievable, they seem like magic. They start their lives looking one way and then turn into something completely different. **This process is called complete metamorphosis.**

EGG

The first stage of complete metamorphosis is the egg. After the moth lays its eggs, it usually takes less than two weeks for them to hatch.

Luna moth egg

Newly hatched caterpillar

Moths lay their eggs on leaves so that when the caterpillars hatch, they have plenty to eat.

LARVA

The second stage of complete metamorphosis is the larva.

Larvae love to eat! They need to grow big and strong before their huge transformation. In moths and butterflies, the larval stage is a caterpillar.

Luna moth caterpillar

PUPA

The third stage of complete metamorphosis is the pupa. This is when the big transformation happens! The pupa cannot move, so it needs to be camouflaged to protect it from predators.

Moth pupa

Moth pupae are often wrapped in silk or buried underground to keep them safe.